ENTREPRENEUR GUIDE TO RELATIONSHIPS

Enhance romantic partnerships, friendships, and parent-child relationships

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Relationships Matter for Entrepreneurs

As Extraverts, Entrepreneurs love interacting with other people. They light up a room, drawing everyone's attention by spurring fun, lively, and sometimes pointed conversations. Whether it's a hip party or a family reunion, gathering with other people energizes Entrepreneurs, showing them at their colorful, confident, and magnetic best. Enthusiastic and spontaneous, people with this personality type make life more interesting for those people around them – including their romantic partners, their friends, and if they become parents, their children.

But this doesn't mean that Entrepreneurs' relationships always go smoothly. People with this personality type can have a blunt, candid communication style that may hurt or offend more sensitive types. And Entrepreneurs may sometimes find themselves at odds with friends and loved ones who can't keep up with their high-flying, adrenaline-seeking pace.

In these pages, we'll discuss how Entrepreneurs can build the thriving, varied relationships they crave. Along the way, we'll cover the strengths that people with this personality type bring to their romantic relationships, their friendships, and their roles as parents – as well as how they can deal with the interpersonal challenges that may threaten to get in their way. Curious and adaptable, Entrepreneurs are more than capable of experimenting with new strategies and approaches to ensure that they can create and maintain the enjoyable, lasting connections that make life all the more worth living.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Romantic Relationships

Entrepreneurs tend to be enthusiastic, often unpredictable individuals who know how to enjoy the present moment and have fun regardless of what they're doing – this applies to their relationships as well. People with this personality type are very good at improvisation, and this trait is usually clearly visible, especially when Entrepreneurs are still dating. Whatever happens, their partners can never complain that their relationships were boring.

Dating and Single Entrepreneurs

Entrepreneurs enjoy practical, fun activities and encourage their partners to explore them as well. It's very unlikely that someone with this personality type enjoys long conversations revolving around philosophical topics – rather, they'll come up with yet another little hobby or an interesting idea. However, every stick has two ends and the Entrepreneurs' need for excitement can also endanger the stability of their relationships. If they get bored, they're prone to seek other sources of excitement – and this may result in them looking for new partners. As Entrepreneurs also tend to be very charming and popular, this is rarely a daunting task for them.

This doesn't mean that all Entrepreneurs are unfaithful in romantic relationships. While they're more likely to engage in risky behavior than most other personality types, they're also rational thinkers, able to control such urges if they so choose. Besides the thirst for excitement they're known for, people with this personality type also dislike long-term planning and prefer dealing with things as they come, taking

everything day by day. This attitude permeates their relationships as well – they simply reevaluate their commitments daily and adjust their behavior accordingly.

Entrepreneurs are very perceptive and able to notice even the slightest change in their partners' moods or behaviors. Even though they aren't very sensitive or emotional, this impressive perceptiveness makes it easier for Entrepreneurs to recognize their beloveds' needs and desires. And, since Entrepreneurs always know how to surprise their partners, their unpredictability and curiosity are likely to keep the romantic flames burning – if they're willing to put in the effort.

Entrepreneurs in the Bedroom

From a sexual perspective, Entrepreneurs tend to like to have fun and enjoy the physical bond with their partners. People with this personality type also tend to be very sensual and willing to experiment. They usually find it easy to separate sex and love, which can also cause tension in their relationships. Many other personality types see intimacy as one of the best ways to express their love and expect their Entrepreneur sweethearts to verbalize their feelings or at least express them in non-verbal ways in such situations. In contrast, Entrepreneurs tend to approach intimacy from a much more physical perspective.

Potential Role Pairings

Let's now look at the relationship dynamic between different type Roles and see how those combinations work in romantic relationships. Each combination brings different things into romance, sometimes positive and sometimes negative – knowing what to expect can help further down the road. However, everyone is unique, and what's true for one may not be true for another.

Entrepreneur–Analyst Relationships

Both Entrepreneurs and Analysts prefer rationality, and neither is very comfortable in the realm of emotions. This combination can create compatible couples who savor each other's logic, or it can hinder the deepening of their emotional lives, depending on their overall needs and desires. Though in different ways, both types are oriented toward finding solutions, and this enhances this relationship combination.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Relationships

Analysts are Intuitive Thinkers. When these types begin relationships with Entrepreneurs, who are Observant Prospectors, it can be one of the most challenging, yet potentially most rewarding combinations.

Analysts have heads full of ideas, visions for the future, and complicated systems. They seek and absorb knowledge. There's a constant deconstruction and reconstruction of ideas on a higher order going on all the time with Analysts.

Entrepreneurs live fully in the present. They're curious about everything – except long-winded conversations based on abstractions and ideas. Always looking for what's new and exciting, they often seek challenges of a material and physical nature they can master or conquer, such as a musical instrument or a craft. However, both types enjoy solving things: for Analysts, it's theoretical puzzles, and for Entrepreneurs, it's finding solutions to real and immediate problems.

So, what happens when Entrepreneurs and Analysts get together on dates? Starting from an optimistic place, Analysts might impress Entrepreneurs with their theories for a while if they can connect them

to something practical. Technically-oriented Analysts who are talking about writing computer code, for example, may excite Entrepreneurs who typically appreciate tools and devices. Analysts, on the other hand, may enjoy Entrepreneurs' spontaneity and the practical perspective they bring to conversations.

Should Analysts and Entrepreneurs become serious and commit to each other, each type might appreciate the other's lack of concern for social convention. There won't be as much pressure as there might be with Sentinels. They can go through life together nearly oblivious to social expectations if they so choose. They may also appreciate the breathing room likely to be granted by their partners. Analysts can seem almost entirely detached from their home lives when in the middle of a project. This could work out well for Entrepreneurs, as it gives them ample time to discover more about their world in their way. Nobody is likely to accuse pairs made up of these types of smothering each other.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Relationships

Sometimes the schism between the Intuitive and Observant traits is too great to bridge, and these romantic partners may spend time wondering what they're doing wrong, why their significant others seem to misunderstand them all the time, and why they just don't listen.

While Entrepreneurs aren't exceedingly sensitive to others' opinions, Analysts should always be aware they can strike others as being condescending. Analysts can easily convey to Entrepreneurs that their work or contribution to the world may not be as "deep" and, therefore, not as important. This may come across in subtle ways, but it also wouldn't be too far-fetched to imagine Analysts announcing it out loud. Coming across as superior can cause a lot of hurt in relationships, and Analysts must learn to take care of their lovers' feelings.

Analysts may also be attracted to Entrepreneurs' looser, fun-loving nature and see this characteristic as something that could balance their own more serious lives. Too much spontaneity, however, may color Entrepreneurs as too frivolous in their Analyst partners' eyes.

Entrepreneurs may become impatient with Analysts' constant hunger for more knowledge and their need to theorize about everything. Entrepreneurs might look at their partners as stodgy or out-of-touch with anything the least bit interesting. Should Analysts go on too long and slip into the theoretical, as they often do, they may quickly lose their Entrepreneur love interests.

Finally, small details aren't likely to interest Analysts, nor are they usually involved with a lot that's hands-on and mundane. This may leave Entrepreneurs to deal with such matters in their shared household in their somewhat casual fashion. While it may sound like a small issue, things like this can take on exaggerated importance when the clothes are piled high in the middle of the bedroom floor.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Analyst Relationships

Luckily, all isn't lost for Entrepreneur–Analyst lovers. Both types can acknowledge their differences and turn them into strengths that neutralize each other's weaknesses.

Let's begin with taking a deeper look at Analysts' seeming lack of emotion. While Analysts may appear at times as if they're without feelings, the truth is they often feel quite deeply. They just don't necessarily feel comfortable expressing their emotions. Entrepreneurs may learn in time that it's just as possible to hurt their Analyst partners' feelings as it is anyone else's. Analysts need to come out of their cloud of concepts occasionally, and there's no better way than being invited to play in their Entrepreneur lovers' playgrounds of discovery. So, rather than becoming irritated at what they perceive as Analysts' stodginess, Entrepreneurs can encourage Analyst partners to come along on their adventures and to learn to appreciate their perspectives as well.

To build better balance into these relationships, Entrepreneurs can try to:

- Bring them into their world – occasionally. Entrepreneurs might want to invite their Analyst partners, who typically overthink everything, to try experiences that involve a more hands-on and spontaneous approach, such as introducing them to an artisan craft or a physical

skill like rock climbing or dancing. Physical intimacy is a great way to lure Analysts away from their preoccupations. However, such calls to action should be done in moderation. "Fixing" Analysts to make them more like themselves may be tempting for Entrepreneurs, but there's nothing to fix. They are who they are. But occasional excursions into each other's worlds may help build balance into these relationships.

- Save spontaneity for the right time. Entrepreneurs can remember that Analyst partners don't share their love for the present moment; in fact, their constant spontaneity may exhaust Analysts. Entrepreneurs can prioritize and store their spontaneous impulses for use later if necessary. They may want to occasionally make it a priority to skip a beat so that Analysts they love have the room they need to deliberate without the distraction of the Entrepreneurs' constant busyness. "There's no reason to do this right now. Let's think about it for a bit," may be all Analysts need to hear occasionally from Entrepreneurs to feel more at home in various situations. Look for opportunities to indulge their preferences.
- Set some ground rules about communication. This should be easy for two such problem-solving types. Neither type is particularly sensitive to feelings, so a communication construct that, for lack of a better word, "artificially" protects feelings may be helpful. For example, they can take an inventory of communication that feels hurtful or demeaning. From that list, decide what's out of bounds, what isn't, and why. Rules, such as using "I feel" statements to take responsibility and avoid directly placing blame, can be helpful. ("When you do that... I feel...") These sorts of rules not only cue their partners that they're entering hurtful territory but also deliberately identify when something touches an emotion. In this way, they can also help each other access their feelings more.

Both Analysts and Entrepreneurs can benefit from taking the time to understand each other's personality types. These types can suspend judgment and consider that both styles are legitimate – one approach isn't better than the other. Accepting that each type serves a purpose in their relationships can help them to appreciate each other's differences – and, most importantly, help both Analysts and Entrepreneurs resist the temptation to try to change each other.

Entrepreneur–Diplomat Relationships

Thinking and Feeling types make decisions in markedly different ways. Throw in the Observant and Intuitive trait differences, and Entrepreneur–Diplomat relationships are potential messes – or glorious examples of when two very different people come together and create something wonderful. They have so much to offer each other. Entrepreneurs add their bias toward practical action, and Diplomats add a deliberate humanistic and visionary counterbalance. When they go beyond tolerating each other's differences to valuing them, great things are likely to happen for these couples.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Diplomat Relationships

Diplomats are Intuitive Feelers with a huge emphasis on Feeling, which is why this pairing can be difficult for Entrepreneurs (Observant, Thinking) who champion practicality over emotion. However, when differences are accommodated, Entrepreneur–Diplomat love affairs can be dynamic.

Diplomats have heads full of creative ideas and dreams, and they see things through their human values lens. They approach other people with an eye for bringing out their potential and strive to find opportunities for both individual and community growth. They're also romantic and sometimes idealize their relationships, placing the objects of their affection on pedestals.

Entrepreneurs live fully in the present. They're always looking for what is new and exciting. Rather than focus on people, as their Diplomat partners do, the human factor can come in second for Entrepreneurs

when they have a problem to solve or a skill to master. It's not that they're amoral or that they don't care about people. People usually fascinate them in an objective sort of way – but tinkering with the tasks and problems before them fascinates Entrepreneurs even more.

When dating, Entrepreneurs' free spirit and enthusiasm for living in the moment may enthrall Diplomats, who may project romantic qualities onto these clever "bohemians," fascinated by their desire for freedom and novelty and their virtuosity in their chosen interests.

Similarly, Entrepreneurs may, at first, be curious about the almost mystical essence that surrounds Diplomats, and their approach to life that feels foreign to this earthbound type. When these two types date, it can be an exciting time full of energy and anticipation. Entrepreneurs are playful and enjoy novelty. Diplomats have a fondness for metaphors and symbolism. This combination almost makes these couples perfect candidates for role-playing in the bedroom.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Diplomat Relationships

Perhaps the biggest issue for this type combination is that Diplomats may see Entrepreneurs' behaviors as cold-hearted and shallow at times, while Entrepreneurs may view Diplomats as too soft and unrealistic. In time, these lovers could revert to their core preferences. Entrepreneurs are likely to complain that their partners are too emotional or irrational, and Diplomats tend to respond that Entrepreneurs are cold and heartless.

Diplomats may try unsuccessfully to help reluctant Entrepreneur sweethearts go deeper into themselves to discover greater potential. They may grow tired of what they see as their lovers' superficial need for novelty and good times. Entrepreneurs, meanwhile, may find Diplomats' fuzzy world of ideas and feelings annoying and try to bring them down to earth. Diplomats' tendency to live inside their heads may become a major turn-off for their experience-oriented Entrepreneur partners. And, just like that, the exciting and interesting may become a source of frustration and resentment for both types.

These two hold very different values, and this even translates to the bedroom. Entrepreneurs can hold little attachment when it comes to sex, while Diplomats may consider it a spiritual experience. This can lead to pain, as Diplomats expect some sort of metaphysical connection between them, and Entrepreneurs who just want their romance to be light-hearted and fun may find it easy to leave once they sense Diplomats are taking things too seriously.

With less serious relationships, Entrepreneurs would rather flee than try to fix problems. However, when deeply committed relationships are in danger, both personality types must come together to decide if their romance, despite all its differences and foreign aspects, is worth fighting for.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Diplomat Relationships

With all romantic relationships, it's recommended that partners take the time to learn about each other, and this goes doubly so for Entrepreneur–Diplomat relationships. These couples can thrive if they choose to practice acceptance and flexibility. However, they first need to work hard to find common ground and allow themselves to embrace and understand each other's differences.

For Diplomats, it's pertinent to understand that though Entrepreneurs have the Thinking trait, it doesn't mean that they're unemotional. Both Thinkers and Feelers are capable of profound emotions – however, Thinkers tend to hide those feelings from the outside world. They want to stay in control and not lose their heads regardless of the circumstances. This creates their aura of indifference.

Likewise, Entrepreneurs should realize the dominance of the Feeling trait doesn't mean that their Diplomat sweethearts are irrational – they're simply using a different set of criteria, putting harmony and sensitivity above cold, hard facts. Feelers tend to show their emotions quite clearly, as opposed to containing them as Thinkers do. However, their decision process may still be rational.

Both these perspectives are valid, and this is one of the most important lessons for those in Entrepreneur–Diplomat relationships. If both types

of partners are tolerant and open-minded, Thinker–Feeler relationships like theirs can be very inspiring and successful, with Entrepreneurs making fact-based decisions and Diplomats bringing warmth and harmony into their romance.

More than just accepting each other's emotional outlook, here are things that Entrepreneurs can do to improve their relationships.

- Be tolerant. Remember that Diplomats may not prioritize facts as much as Entrepreneurs do – they're likely to prioritize harmony, values, and morals instead. It's not a wrong decision-making method, just a different one.
- Be careful with criticism. Feelers like Diplomats are often vulnerable to criticism, and Thinkers like Entrepreneurs are sometimes excessively blunt, so be careful when pointing something out and try to do it in a calm, non-confrontational manner. It's okay to be honest, but honesty works just as well with a shot of kindness and gentleness most of the time. And remember, if a line is crossed occasionally and damage is done, a sincere apology is a good place to start repairing hurt feelings.
- Slow down occasionally. Remember that Diplomats don't share Entrepreneurs' love for the present moment. Entrepreneurs' bias toward action may exhaust these visionaries, who tend to prefer to stop to consider the consequences before acting, and then take some time to reflect afterward. Understanding this difference and honoring it adequately can make Diplomats feel more comfortable in their romances with Entrepreneurs.
- Learn what's important to Diplomats. Entrepreneurs' pragmatic, *laissez-faire* attitudes toward life may often clash with their Diplomat partners' deeply-held values. Adopting an "ends justify the means" approach in morally ambiguous situations may make their lovers very uncomfortable. They should be aware of that and try to find the middle ground between utilitarianism and idealism. Remember how important their values are to Diplomats. In relationships with them, these things aren't to be trifled with.

Entrepreneurs' traits are the opposite of the Diplomats' core traits. However, this doesn't mean they can't fall in love and share their

lives with one another. Tapping into the powerful perspectives of empathy and justice Diplomats bring can help Entrepreneurs add those elements to their crafts and solutions. Diplomats who embrace Entrepreneurs as partners are likely to experience new practical energy in their lives that may bring them closer to realizing their dreams. There is, beyond a doubt, much potential for great romance when these types become couples.

Entrepreneur–Sentinel Relationships

While Sentinels and Entrepreneurs might share many of the same preferences, their contrasting Prospecting and Judging traits are likely to make all the difference. Like the small rudder on a large ship decides its direction, these tendencies turn Sentinels right and Entrepreneurs left.

Starting with what they have in common, both types enjoy practicality that comes with living in the "here and now." In their shared love affairs, they don't have to put up with all the theories and abstractions that they might with Analysts or Diplomats. Each likes to live in a practical, real world where they manipulate material things. In sharing this focus, they speak the same down-to-earth language.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Sentinel Relationships

Sentinels are Judging individuals and enjoy planning and committing to things as opposed to keeping their options open. Entrepreneurs, on the other hand, like to keep things free and easy, and they're always

looking for alternatives and opportunities. Relationships between Judging individuals and Prospecting individuals may often be rocky and challenging, but there's a lot of potential for strong and dynamic romance once these two types put in the time to learn about each other.

Sentinels and Entrepreneurs are likely to find common ground in their Observant trait. Both are likely to prefer relying on their senses over introspection – they'll spend more time keeping their feet on the ground instead of exploring the world of ideas.

Relationships between two Observant types are usually very straightforward, practical, and fun – these partners are usually able to handle practical tasks very well, focusing exclusively on real and tangible things. Their pragmatism, down-to-earth attitude, and a "Let's just do it!" approach are likely to be great driving forces in their shared relationships.

Sexually, both Role types have a no-nonsense approach to sex and see it as something very physical. Sex stays in the realm of the senses with these lovers and won't be laden with "deeper meaning" as with Diplomats.

For Entrepreneur–Sentinel couples, steady relationships are likely to come more easily than other pairings. They complement each other and provide a perfect yin to the other's yang. When Entrepreneurs mature and see the value of settling down, they often gravitate toward Sentinels who settle rather naturally and enthusiastically. Even Entrepreneurs understand that stability has its place in life and may look to Sentinels to provide more of it in theirs.

Sentinels find partners they can nurture and care for in Entrepreneurs. And even Sentinels crave a little excitement in their lives if it's not too disruptive. It should also be mentioned that Sentinels and Explorers make up most of the population. Statistically, they're more likely to run into each other in the dating pool.

Observant types form most of the population (75–85%), and many traditions and social norms revolve around their traits. They're unlikely to have difficulties understanding each other or finding things to do. All Observant individuals enjoy things they can see, touch, and feel – therefore, such exciting activities are probably attractive to both these

partners, and neither needs to worry about being misunderstood. This is a great advantage both in the dating phase and later in their shared relationships.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Sentinel Relationships

The differences most obvious in this type pairing involve decision-making and certainty. True to their name, Entrepreneurs are ever-curious and often reluctant to commit easily if something feels like it's going to be too restrictive. It's all right with them if everything is a little ambiguous. They like to see where things are going, and they navigate the flow of life instinctively and with great enthusiasm.

Sentinels, on the other hand, prefer to know that things are going the way they've determined they should (mostly through tradition and habit.) They prefer certainty with little room for ambiguity and often declare their truths in absolute terms. On a date, Sentinels may say, "Let's go to our favorite restaurant for dinner and then a movie. Here are the movie listings. Let's pick a movie before we go." Entrepreneurs might say, "Let's try that new club downtown. I know nothing about it. I'd love to see what it's like." Should their romance grow into something serious, these differing attitudes can come to be very important. Inflexibility and favoring only one's own way is likely to be detrimental to such relationships.

Another issue is that some Sentinel and Entrepreneur couples' relationships begin to mimic those of parents and children, with Sentinels acting the part of the grown-ups and Entrepreneurs taking the role of rascally children. This can work – until it doesn't. At some point, having all the responsibility of holding the ship steady may cause Sentinels to become resentful, especially if Entrepreneurs don't express appreciation for their efforts. Entrepreneurs, in turn, may come to resent being managed like infants – and may suddenly demand to make their own decisions based on their need for adrenaline and action.

Once Entrepreneurs become the "rebellious children" in their romance, there's a great deal of conflict potential. Sentinels may feel their stability

is threatened, and they, in turn, may double down on the aspects of life that make Entrepreneurs feel confined. It can all get very messy if these couples don't understand these situations and work with each other to correct them.

Entrepreneurs' and Sentinels' combined pragmatism and focus on the concrete are very useful in everyday life, but they may have difficulties with imagination, reflection, and growth as individuals and as couples. This doesn't mean that Observant types are unimaginative – quite the contrary, they're often brilliant artists. However, their tendency to rely on the sensory world and undervalue abstract and philosophical thoughts often lead their relationships to stagnant places that lack meaningful dimensions. They may lack a sense of purpose unique to each in their relationship. Each performs in their own style, and yet neither is sure why.

Should one of the partners think too much about it, it can disrupt everything in their relationships they've grown accustomed to. Midlife and similar crises are the product of such disruptions. And, like most Explorers, Entrepreneurs may feel a pull to move on to something new and different, regardless of which type disrupts the comfortable flow of their relationships.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Sentinel Relationships

Entrepreneurs and Sentinels, if they're willing to compromise, can turn their differences into major strengths, covering each type's respective weaknesses. To achieve this, they need to make conscious efforts to meet each other halfway. Entrepreneurs should resist the urge to always seek something new and exciting, even when it's very difficult to stick to the plan or manage all the chores. Meeting their Sentinel partners halfway or more can make a difference in their relationships.

Here are some things Entrepreneurs can do:

- Show appreciation. While Sentinels may not ask for it, they're energized by receiving recognition for what they do. Considering everything they do to keep things running smoothly, showing them a little appreciation is a small price to pay.

- Help around the house, even when the chores are boring. While precise and diligent with the things that interest them, Entrepreneurs likely have a much higher tolerance for general disorder when compared to their Sentinel partners. To make Sentinels more comfortable, Entrepreneurs can keep a close eye on their housekeeping duties, such as making sure to wash their dirty dishes without having to be asked.
- Be imaginative. Observant couples often focus too much on routines or physical things. Don't be afraid of exploring ideas without knowing whether they're practical or implementable.
- Keep the flame alive. Remember what the attraction was in the first place. This may be essential for Entrepreneurs who are always looking for something different.

Entrepreneurs must understand and fully use the complementary nature of their relationships with Sentinels. By recognizing they voluntarily joined with partners who value structure and stability, they can strive to be aware of the importance of "playing by the rules" within their relationship. They can also show appreciation for all their Sentinel lovers offer them in the diligent and giving ways only Sentinels can.

Entrepreneur–Explorer Relationships

Someone to explore with – at least, that's what one might assume is the draw when two Explorers fall in love. But even such a match made in heaven can have nooks and crannies that make them less than perfect under the right circumstances. The Observant and Prospecting combination produces much energy and movement that, when multiplied in couples, can be exciting. But doubling these characteristics

in romantic relationships can also drain and subject them to impulsive changes. Both partners may need to understand what commitment means to them and be honest with each other.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Explorer Relationships

Old saws would have us believe that "opposites attract," as though human hearts were magnets. So, what happens when two people within the same personality role group take on romance? What happens when Entrepreneurs and other Explorers meet and fall in love?

Fortunately for those who do, no two people are alike, even if they share the same basic personality traits. There are adaptations and nuances that prevent relationships between Entrepreneurs and other Explorers from being the same as looking into a mirror. Degrees of other traits, such as Introversion and Extraversion, can also come into play. But it can be exhilarating for Entrepreneurs to be with those who are like themselves and share the same typical need for novelty.

When Entrepreneurs and other Explorers come together romantically, the emphasis is more likely on the playful and the exciting. This is perhaps the most mercurial of type Roles when it comes to romance. Explorers are more likely than any other type to play the field before they settle down. They may resist being "tied down" in favor of being stimulated by new partners and conquests. They can be flirtatious and enjoy the hunt as much as the catch. Should Entrepreneurs find themselves in committed relationships with other Explorers, they're likely to find a level of flexibility not seen among any other paired types.

Also, emotions can run high with this combination – even Explorers with the Thinking trait are highly influenced by their passion. But while Entrepreneur–Explorer couples sometimes engage in heated exchanges, they're short-lived and probably won't have much impact on how they respond to each other in the long run. Since life is a constant whirl of changes for them, that fight last night is likely "so yesterday" and something to be shrugged off.

Sexually, Entrepreneur–Explorer lovers may indulge in experimentation and, should things feel too dull in the bedroom, one or both may seek

what they regard as more interesting activities elsewhere. Finding ways to spice up their sex lives while staying home may be crucial to their relationships depending on their arrangement. However, these types bring all their senses into play during their more intimate moments, and this can make finding novel approaches to sex easier.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Explorer Relationships

The biggest potential problem for Entrepreneur–Explorer couples is burnout. These couples often live the philosophy behind the line of the Neil Young song: "It's better to burn out than to fade away." Even the most energetic Entrepreneur–Explorer sweethearts can only bear such intensity for so long before it becomes too much. They may tire of too many risks and too much excitement and need to take measures to create stability and "down-time" within their relationships. Failure of these romances is more likely to come from fatigue and lack of novelty rather than incompatibility. A feeling of constant restlessness can get old, even for the most die-hard Entrepreneurs.

When in love, both these types are likely to orchestrate large romantic gestures and "wow" their partners. However, once their relationships become routine, they also may quietly slink out the back door, never to be heard from again. At some point (usually with age), most Entrepreneurs become more domestically inclined and commit to creating homes and families. However, they don't necessarily date with such long-term plans in mind. Their decision to settle down may be spontaneous and almost impulsive. Multiply these behaviors by two, and it's easy to see how romances between Entrepreneurs and other Explorers would be intense – perhaps even the stuff of soap operas.

Both these types tend not to pay so much attention to either the criticisms nor the concerns of others, as they're often immune to both. They base marriage on the "here and now," and the rules and standards within their committed relationships may be lax. While "I do" means something to them, there may always be a feeling that such a commitment is too final and too ironclad for their comfort.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Explorer Relationships

However, love affairs between Entrepreneurs and other Explorers don't have to be just about turmoil and uncertainty. There's plenty of opportunity for shared experiences for these seekers of novelty. Exploring common interests in the arts, crafts, and even business can keep such couples connected and in tune with one another. Entrepreneur–Explorer couples can create stimulating social lives filled with interesting people. The trick for their cohesion is to find as many adventures in which they both can join as possible. Such bonding of interests can provide creative stimulation and strong romances that last for lifetimes.

Here are some tips for Entrepreneur–Explorer couples:

- Give partners space. With Entrepreneurs and other Explorers, familiarity breeds contempt. If too confined or things become too routine, they may feel a need to escape. It's better to allow a little fresh air into these relationships by providing elbow room than to allow perpetual sameness to stagnate into what Explorers might see as dreary house arrest minus the ankle bracelet. Leave enough room so there isn't the panicky need to flee.
- Don't forget the future. Explorers in committed relationships can get some outside help to tend to their future. For example, financial advisers who manage money can be helpful for relationships focused almost exclusively on the present. There are all manner of professionals who can be of service to couples who would rather someone else take care of that stuff, anyway.
- Find an anchor, but one with a long chain. Try to find some downtime together for relaxing and quiet fun. Create some custom-made family traditions to help anchor the relationship, such as sitting down regularly to a Sunday dinner together – and take turns adding an interesting new dish to the menu each week. This much consistency typically goes against the natural grain of most Entrepreneurs and other Explorers but expanding their comfort zones can build some structure into their relationships. Blending homegrown expressions of togetherness with opportunities for each to independently express themselves can help create a wholesome balance.

To non-Explorers, relationships between Entrepreneurs and other Explorers may sound chaotic and unconventional. But such couples aren't likely to be so concerned with what others think of them anyway. The trick isn't for them to defy their independent and exploratory natures and try to conform to prefab expectations when they enter relationships with each other. The trick is to learn how to bring those characteristics into a romance in ways that work for them and leave both partners happy. Think of it as another solution to find – and another avenue to explore.

Conclusion

The words "passion" and "romance" are close cousins, and we often find the word "passion" assigned to descriptions of Entrepreneur characteristics. While admittedly, in the context of this personality type, the word passion is mostly attached to careers and activities that Entrepreneurs enjoy, they can also extend that positive energy toward those they love, and, in doing so, form passionate romances. While they choose rationality as their primary tool for making decisions, Entrepreneurs are far from cold, and they can be very effective soul mates.

Consider also how attractive devil-may-care people are, especially to those personality types who need a little relief from the structure and convention that may define their lives. This can be the challenge for such relationships. Sometimes one must be careful of what one asks for. Entrepreneurs can provide such relief with their fun-loving unpredictability. But the shine often wears off, and the other partner's preferences reassert themselves.

But, despite such dangers, love frequently finds a way. There is no such thing as a good or bad match for Entrepreneurs willing to put as much effort into nurturing their relationships as they do perfecting their other skills. One of the hallmark characteristics of Entrepreneurs is their willingness to change course if it leads to practical results. Nothing describes the compromise necessary for successful relationships better.

Friendships

People with the Entrepreneur personality type are the life of the party. With an enviable imagination and invigorating sense of spontaneity, they're never boring. They love exploring interesting ideas, both in discussion and by seeing things for themselves, so Entrepreneurs always seem to have fun activities hidden up their sleeves. At the same time, people with this personality type are easy-going, tolerant, and charming, making them naturally popular.

Hands-on physical activities like team sports are Entrepreneurs' idea of fun, and these environments give them plenty of chances to make new friends. There's little difficulty for them here – they seem to get along with just about everyone and make new connections wherever they go. Entrepreneurs live in the moment, and as a naturally confident personality type, they worry little about what others think of them. This tends to attract friends who share their attitudes and zest for life.

While not opposed to long philosophical discussions – they often enjoy the intellectual exercise – Entrepreneurs are unlikely to develop friendships based solely around one-on-one discussions about European economic challenges and the role of religion in politics. Straightforward to the point of being blunt, these types call it as they see it, and an honest opinion in a debate is a sure thing. But at their hearts, Entrepreneurs are people of action, preferring to do what can be done rather than talking about what might happen someday. Sitting idle, especially in boredom, is the bane of their existence.

Exploration, excitement, adrenaline, and risk – Entrepreneurs' friends should prepare for all these things. Often enough they're happy to perform for the crowd, but they also tend to encourage their friends to join in. Most personality types might take "thanks but no thanks" personally, but Entrepreneurs are comfortable with who they are, and are more likely just to shrug their shoulders and move on with those friends who are game for adventure.

Entrepreneurs and Friends of Other Types

We'll now go through the main Roles, discussing the challenges and joyful moments that Entrepreneurs are likely to face in their friendships with other personality types.

Entrepreneur–Analyst Friendships

Entrepreneurs and Analysts relate to each other well through their Thinking preference. These friends have the same bias toward the rational, even though they express it differently. Stark honesty comes with that approach, which might not be present with friends who are more emotionally inclined. They're likely friends who can be blunt and open with each other if the bluntness isn't applied too thickly. All things in moderation.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Friendships

Clever Thinkers Get Along

The best thing about having Analyst friends is that they act as rational,

insightful, and strategically-minded advisors to highly practical but sometimes impatient Entrepreneurs. Analysts pride themselves on being objective, even with their closest friends. Those belonging to this type group would have few qualms about criticizing Entrepreneurs' latest ideas or specific actions. Being direct and blunt themselves, Entrepreneurs are likely to feel right at home when it comes to such an approach. Analysts' penchant for conceptual thinking may sometimes frustrate Entrepreneurs, but having friends who are able and willing to look at things from different angles can be invaluable in many situations.

Entrepreneurs and Analysts also share a desire for logic and efficiency. If a challenge interests them, otherwise impulsive Entrepreneurs may spend hours trying to tackle it. With Analysts trying to understand the principles behind the functionality, and Entrepreneurs experimenting with what's in front of them, their partnership can be mutually rewarding. Their principles and perspectives may not always overlap, but there should be enough common ground for both types to benefit from opportunities to share their thoughts with each other.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Friendships

Deficits in Understanding

Entrepreneurs and Analysts also have their fair share of differences that may cause tension in friendships between the two types. The most important of such differences is the way these types take in information. Entrepreneurs are highly practical, live-in-the-moment individuals – as far as they're concerned, it's the real, tangible things that matter most. Analysts mostly focus on what they can imagine and deduce, taking pleasure in coming up with various concepts and ideas. While there are ways to combine the two approaches – for instance, while working on projects that require both planning and execution – these two thinking styles can, nonetheless, turn out to be major barriers with communication and mutual understanding.

Another issue these types may face is that neither of them is likely to find it easy to provide emotional support. Both Entrepreneurs and Analysts can have very strong feelings, but they're neither comfortable

with nor experienced in coping with other people's emotions. This may not be a major issue with day-to-day matters, but nearly every friendship has ups and downs occasionally – bottling up frustration isn't the best long-term strategy.

If these friends don't resolve the underlying problems, sometimes even a simple miscommunication can lead to longstanding disappointment. In such a scenario, either Entrepreneurs or Analysts, being as rational as they are, may ultimately decide that their friendships are just not worth the trouble.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Analyst Friendships

Practical Logic

While these types may have drastically different ways of exploring, expressing creativity, and thinking about the future, they can rely on their common rationality to resolve any differences within their mutual friendship. One very strong thing that Analysts and Entrepreneurs share is an appreciation of effectiveness – they both love to see practical solutions in place and functioning. This shared appreciation isn't limited to technical areas but also applies to the social realm. Especially in matters of pure preference (where to eat, for example), it's only rational to conclude that occasional compromises might be the way to go. Why? Because their friendship is worth it.

When these types experience more serious friction with each other, both can dial down their frustrated sense of superiority and instead focus on finding practical solutions together. Resolving their differing methods and preferences can be as easy as each type opening their minds to see the merits of another perspective and trying it.

Likewise, instead of just arguing for their own way, these friends can respect each other's minds enough to justify those arguments with some facts. Telling friends they're wrong about something only carries hurtful judgment, but showing them better ways that work is a respectful form of disagreement these logical types can handle.

Entrepreneur–Diplomat Friendships

Entrepreneurs and Diplomats often approach things from different angles: Entrepreneurs from a rational, practical level and Diplomats from an idealistic, humanistic level. With effort and acceptance, these differences can be complementary and help each type grow – or they can set up conflict, as each looks askance at the other's position. But some of the best friendships are between those who have enough in common to connect and enough differences to keep it interesting.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Diplomat Friendships

Differences That Inspire

For Entrepreneurs, having close Diplomat friends can be both very rewarding and very perplexing. They may not always understand each other, and yet they may experience mutual wonder as they come to appreciate their very different viewpoints and what they can offer each other.

Diplomats are enthusiastic, passionate, and imaginative individuals – their energy often inspire Entrepreneurs, especially initially, perhaps even giving them exciting new ideas to follow. Diplomats are rare compared to other personality types, and their unusual thinking may be very intriguing to Entrepreneurs. However, that fascination may also include confusion – just like Analysts, Diplomats primarily live in their minds, and this attitude can be foreign to practical-minded and hands-on Entrepreneurs.

Regardless of these issues, Entrepreneur–Diplomat friendships can be inspiring. Empathic and insightful, Diplomats can pull more realistic Entrepreneurs away from their daily concerns, encouraging them to develop their thoughts and ideas. Diplomats have a knack for making

people feel relaxed and comfortable, and restless Entrepreneurs can benefit from such company.

On the other side of the fence, idealistic and often absent-minded Diplomats also benefit from friendships with highly practical and efficiency-oriented Entrepreneurs. They put their ideas into action, and this amazes Diplomats, inspiring them to do the same with their own dreams. As rewarding as brainstorming can be, often there's just no substitute for some positive shared experiences.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Diplomat Friendships

Very Different Priorities

While both friends are likely to share a certain excitement about discovering and experiencing new things (although their definitions of what makes something interesting are likely to be very different), they may also remain enigmas to each other for a long time. This is probably the most challenging combination of all for several reasons. Diplomats' nearly constant soul-searching is as meaningful to them as experiencing things is to Entrepreneurs. These differences can lead to numerous misunderstandings.

Another issue that Entrepreneurs and their Diplomat friends may come across is their shared tendency to neglect day-to-day matters and necessities. Whether it's Entrepreneurs going on unplanned road trips a week before their tax returns are due, or Diplomats forgetting to transfer the rent money amid their volunteer activities, both types sometimes deal with unpleasant surprises – especially if these matters affect them both. Meticulousness isn't always their strong suit. Both types may suffer the consequences of a lack of attention to any mutual responsibilities, or any promises they might make to each other to handle shared tasks.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Diplomat Friendships

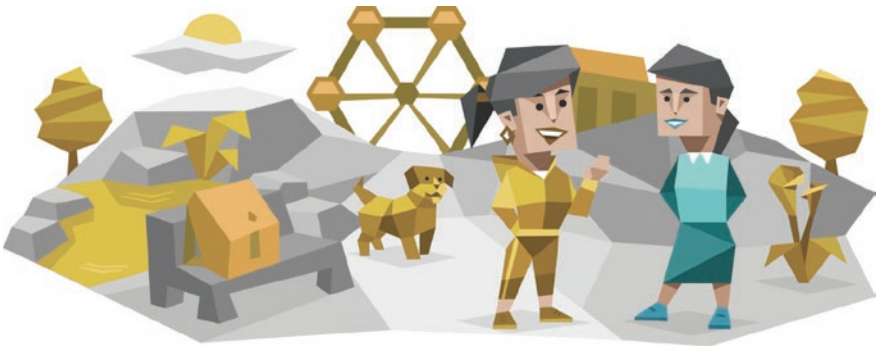
Taking Time to Help Each Other

While these types may not have perfect compatibility in the focus of their day-to-day lives, they find they can enhance the richness of

each other's existence with a little flexibility. Diplomats maintain a remarkable principled sincerity that can beautifully balance Entrepreneurs' sometimes-cynical approach to life. Among Diplomat friends, Entrepreneurs can connect to social rewards that come from thinking about more than just their own lives. Always seeking exciting challenges, Entrepreneurs may unwittingly pass right by warmer human connections. But with Diplomat friends along for the ride, even such energetic and logical types find time to stop and share a smile.

When it comes to rebalancing neglectful attitudes toward everyday life, these types are both far from mastery but can still counterbalance their respective weaknesses. When it's time to focus on necessities all too unexciting for these types to find pleasant, their friendship can provide the missing element of enjoyment. Doing chores and running errands may not be fun alone, but when these friends offer each other their company – and helpful ideas – they can turn anything into a fun adventure.

Entrepreneur–Sentinel Friendships



Entrepreneurs and Sentinels may look very similar glancing at the personality type letters, but what a difference a single letter can make. Where Entrepreneurs are spontaneous, Sentinels foster stability. Where Entrepreneurs are pragmatists not always concerned with the rules, Sentinels uphold every jot and tittle of established standards. These differences, however pronounced, don't necessarily make friendship between the two types impossible. There is much potential when these opposites attract.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Sentinel Friendships

Everyday Companions

Sentinels are numerous and are likely to form a significant part of Entrepreneurs' social circles unless Entrepreneurs are particularly selective. These personality types are likely to be loyal, practical, and down-to-earth friends, always eager to offer advice and support. Sentinel friends help Entrepreneurs stay focused and realistic when necessary – for instance, when they get so caught up in their hobbies or social obligations they find it difficult to spend time on more mundane yet important matters. Sentinels' patience, stability, and sense of loyalty can be invaluable when Entrepreneurs feel confused or uncertain about their chosen paths.

Both Entrepreneurs and Sentinels tend to be practical, with their feet planted firmly on the ground – both friends are likely to focus on activities that engage their senses, such as participating in sports, going on hikes, or working on otherwise tangible things together. As more adventurous and spontaneous individuals, Entrepreneurs may convince Sentinels to let go of their serious, composed attitudes and simply have fun occasionally. Similarly, the structured, orderly style embraced by Sentinels can counterbalance the occasional devil-may-care approach of Entrepreneurs.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Sentinel Friendships

Clashing Senses of Responsibility

The main point of contention in Entrepreneur–Sentinel friendships is likely to be their different understanding of freedom and individualism. Entrepreneurs are famous for their unyielding spirit of independence, seeing many rules and traditions as stifling and redundant limitations. To them, freedom of expression is more important than social cohesion or security.

Sentinels scoff at thinking about someone ignoring social conventions in favor of individualism. From their perspective, stability and security are topmost concerns, and these types are likely to argue that the

needs of the many outweigh the needs of the few. These differences may lead to some heated discussions revolving around flexibility and responsibility.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Sentinel Friendships

Truly Respecting Differences

There's little these types can do to rebalance friction in their mutual friendship unless they're both willing to acknowledge the virtues of the other's perspective. This doesn't mean they must adopt those viewpoints as their own, but recognizing that different lifestyles can work for different people give these two types a chance to bridge their differences.

Entrepreneurs can appreciate how Sentinels enjoy the sense of security stability brings, and respect that what may seem limited or restricted in the short term may create strong long-term success. In turn, Sentinels can appreciate that while a spontaneous, risk-taking approach may not be for them, Entrepreneurs can – and do – make it work in their own lives.

In true friendships, seeing chums happy and successful is more important than being right. Sentinels can view their Entrepreneur friends with supportive amazement instead of dismay, knowing that win or lose, they're likely to be able to pick themselves up and begin anew.

These friends also do well to accept input from each other, as they're both exceedingly proficient in their own ways, and equally capable of giving each other some balance. Sentinels who learn to take measured risks by following in their Entrepreneur friends' footsteps can undoubtedly increase their opportunities in life, and Entrepreneurs who listen to the wise advice of Sentinel friends may sidestep some of their own worst mistakes.

Entrepreneur–Explorer Friendships

"Live for the moment" could be the motto for Entrepreneurs who strike up friendships with other Explorers. The exhilaration of such spontaneous and active relationships is likely to be heady for both since they're probably asked to conform and slow down in so many other facets of their lives. However, there is no perfect friendship and even this seemingly seamless match has hazards to avoid – mostly because there can be too much of a good thing.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Explorer Friendships

Lively Compatibility

For Entrepreneurs, having other close Explorer friends is like looking into a mirror. All Explorers are practical and inventive individuals, so it's very unlikely that such friends would ever run out of things to do. Furthermore, all Explorers prefer to bond over shared activities, so it's likely that such friends find it easy to maintain their relationships regardless of the difficulties, often pushing each other to explore new hobbies or put more efforts into existing ones.

While such free-thinking types as Entrepreneurs and other Explorer types may have minor differences, it's likely that such friends feel as if they've found true "mind mates." Explorers' spontaneity, boldness, and willingness to push limits make them fun, interesting friends, and give them plenty of opportunities to bond with each other. The main challenge for Entrepreneurs, however, is often finding other Explorers (especially with similar hobbies) to befriend. Keeping such friendships alive once formed is relatively easy for them.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Explorer Friendships

Shared Chaos

A key challenge for Entrepreneurs and their Explorer friends is likely to come from the same source that fuels their connection – their similarity. Having friends who think similarly can be fun and reassuring, but it can also put these types in a bubble, isolating them from criticism and growth. There's a risk that they'll convince each other that their behaviors and attitudes are fine, even when some obvious issues need to be addressed – such as dealing with mundane yet necessary tasks. A shared love of spontaneity with little emphasis on responsibility can leave these friends mired in disorder.

Another issue that Entrepreneurs and their Explorer friends may face is that they both are likely to place more importance on practical and tangible things than on imagination and mental exercises. It may be a good idea for both types to encourage each other to find time for intellectual growth and discussions about the past or the future. While Entrepreneurs and their Explorer friends enjoy living in the moment, failing to stop and think about the long-term picture occasionally can cause problems.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Explorer Friendships

Embracing New Ideas Together

Entrepreneurs and their Explorer friends tend to be very open, and one of the best ways for them to avoid being limited by their similarities is to be open to including different kinds of friends in their social circles. Entrepreneurs are great at figuring out how to fit unusual pieces together and can apply this cleverness to social relationships. Seeking new friends with very different points of view – for example, from other Role groups – can be an exciting adventure with many possible gains. One of the greatest things that Entrepreneur–Explorer friends can get from diverse people is a new perspective on their own lives.

This can help these friends develop beyond just living for the moment and its pleasures and become better strategic thinkers, dreamers, and responsible doers. Entrepreneurs and Explorers benefit from

friendships that encourage them to take fresh approaches to things now and then, balancing out their focus on immediate desires. Such friends may find that not only does this make their lives more secure, but it also can enable them to plan and experience new adventures together. Forethought can reveal even more amazing opportunities than spontaneity can because it allows these types to inject some of their own preferences into an outcome – instead of just making do with whatever happens.

Conclusion

Entrepreneurs are Extraverts, which generally means they know plenty of people. However, not all those people are destined to become true friends. But for those who are, the benefits are many. The Entrepreneurs' bias toward action is likely to bring an extra measure of energy into the lives of those they befriend, and their rational practicality is likely to broaden or shift their friends' perspectives. Friendship with unique Entrepreneurs can be something to treasure.

Entrepreneurs who try to develop friendships are likely to be more anchored and balanced because of those relationships. They aren't always comfortable with their feelings, and bonding platonically with others can help them increase their emotional intelligence. If they find someone who shares their interests, such a partner is likely to be prized. Entrepreneurs may have to give up some of the independence they hold so dear, but the tradeoff may be well worth it.

Parenthood

Playful and Curious

In a lot of ways, Entrepreneurs are what many children would consider the perfect parents. Fun-loving and playful, flexible and understanding, people with the Entrepreneur personality type genuinely enjoy spending time with their children and know how to make sure everyone's having a good time. Entrepreneurs have a natural curiosity and spontaneity that's a perfect match for young children's wonder and insatiable desire to learn.

Entrepreneurs love hands-on activities, and their kids are likely to have someone to play catch with or to help them build a model for school. These parents welcome and encourage sports, hiking, and other practical, proactive hobbies. Given their aversion to rules and schedules, they aren't likely to force their children into clubs and teams. If their kids want to play softball, great – if not, well, they'll just find something else to do. Maybe the greatest thing about Entrepreneur parents is that they see their children as equal members of the family.

Entrepreneurs with a balanced approach to parenting give their children freedom, encourage them to use their own judgment (especially with the minor stuff), and to follow their hearts – to heck with what other people think. Using their knack for picking up on even the slightest changes in others' behaviors and habits, Entrepreneur parents keep a close enough eye on their kids so that they can step in with extra guidance when things go wrong.

Insensitive to Emotional Needs

Entrepreneurs have one significant parental challenge, though: emotional bonding. As with any Thinking type, feelings tend to be seen by these parents as irrational distractions, rather than tools for expression and connection. If their children are Feeling types, this can be a source of tension in these families. Frank honesty isn't always the best way to support children.

This lack of sensitivity, combined with their sometimes-brash behavior, can be especially overwhelming to Introverted kids who tend to bristle in the presence of overbearing behavior. Entrepreneurs have no qualms with spontaneous socialization or getting up in front of large groups of people. But Introverted children are likely to be intimidated by any spontaneous socialization, especially if it involves large groups or strangers. Entrepreneur parents, especially when they take an unbalanced parenting approach, may take their children's hesitation or quietness as a serious lack of social skills – a problem they need to resolve.

It can be a struggle for Entrepreneurs to address some of these potential issues as they're often unaware of their own emotional needs. This can cause a lack of self-awareness and inappropriate emotional expression, which may be both confusing and hurtful when it affects their sons and daughters.

Entrepreneur parents stressed out about work situations may snap at their school-aged children who ask them for help with their nightly homework. They may not realize that their frustrations stem from their situations at work and aren't a result of their kids' requests. Angry Entrepreneur parents may berate their children for not getting their homework done, or even accuse them of not being smart enough to do their homework on their own. Their own emotions can cloud their judgment and create unbalanced, negative behaviors and attitudes they take out on those around them.

Bridging the Emotional Gap

Insensitivity can create a significant emotional gap between parents and their children but, with the right focus and motivation, Entrepreneur parents can build positive, lasting bonds. Thankfully, even though they aren't necessarily empathetic or compassionate, they're sociable and enjoy connecting with other people.

While they may view feelings and emotions as irrational, they're exceptionally good at picking up shifts in behavior or attitude that can provide clues about their children's feelings. Whether or not they believe those feelings are valid, at the very least, they can use their abilities to acknowledge them and show they care. Just knowing that their parents acknowledge their emotional needs can make kids feel understood and accepted for who they are. This is especially true for Introverted and Feeling children, who often feel misunderstood or criticized for their more sensitive natures.

Entrepreneurs can also benefit from having more sensitive parenting partners to help them out, and the healthy bonds they form through their shared activities can help to bridge the gap. These parents also have the added benefit of direct, understanding relationships – their children won't feel so much like they must hide their mistakes and challenges, the holy grail of parent-child communication.

Parent–Child Type Pairings

Talking about personality types and children is always an interesting proposition. While most see personality as something that is at least partly genetic and inherent, those influences may only lightly touch a child or only be softly apparent during childhood. Childhood is about experimenting, learning, and adapting. This means their behavior is often exploratory rather than permanently defining. There may be hints of a personality type, but with so much adapting going on, it may be hard to pinpoint their consistent traits exactly. And since children aren't self-aware enough to take a personality test, they don't have the same advantages as adults who can answer questions describing their preferences.

Therefore, when we talk about the Analyst child, for example, we are referring mainly to children who may show a preference for a rational approach – even if it's a sporadic preference. But we urge caution toward labeling children until they're older and can tell us their preferences themselves. Childhood is all about discovery, and we advocate giving them a chance to do that on their own and in their own time without the confines of labels.

But for the sake of our discussion, we'll describe things that Entrepreneurs may want to notice when parenting children who engage in certain trait behaviors – whether those behaviors are a phase or prove to be more consistent.

Entrepreneur Parent and an Analyst Child

Curious and Driven

Analyst-leaning children are likely to be intellectually-minded, curious, and very imaginative. Their creativity and open-mindedness are likely to delight their Entrepreneur parents, who tend to be intrigued by their children's willingness to explore the unknown, which is in a way like their own penchant for improvisation.

Entrepreneurs and Analysts share an interest in discovering how things work, which is why it's unlikely these parents have major difficulties communicating with their children or coming up with interesting activities. Furthermore, Analyst kids are focused and motivated once they find something that interests them. Entrepreneurs share this trait, and they'll probably be delighted to see that their daughters and sons are as determined as they are.

Practicality versus Theory

The core engines that drive this exploration and curiosity are different for Entrepreneurs and Analysts. Entrepreneurs usually enjoy exploring things simply because they present a challenge, and then either move on to something more interesting or spend time honing their skills. Like other Explorers, Entrepreneurs focus on the tangible and the real. Analysts are less concerned about practical applications and more about why something works the way it does, from a mostly intellectual perspective. They want to understand the hidden principles, systems, and patterns behind things, even when they offer few tangible benefits.

Analyst children may not hesitate to question their Entrepreneur parents' suggestions or conclusions, often because they're interested in why their parents think the way they do and not necessarily because they don't

trust them. However, such questions may also frustrate Entrepreneur parents, who may likely see them as a waste of time and wonder why their sons and daughters just don't give something a try or focus on experimenting instead. Analyst children aren't likely to be persuaded by statements such as, "Because it works," or, "This is the best way."

Finding Shared Interests

Analyst children are unlikely to require much emotional support, which is a relief for direct and rational Entrepreneurs. Analysts are more self-sufficient than Feeling types, although this may also cause problems when there's a genuine need to open up and discuss something.

Often, Entrepreneurs bond with their Analyst children through shared activities and hobbies rather than heartfelt discussions about principles and values. It may be a good idea for Entrepreneur parents to make conscious efforts to encourage their kids to partake in something they're doing, such as a shared hobby or sport. In this way, they can develop mutual appreciation and understanding.

Entrepreneur Parent and a Diplomat Child

Inquisitive and Open-Minded

Even though Entrepreneurs and Diplomats are complete opposites on many fronts, there's also some overlap among their traits. Diplomat-leaning children are likely to be inquisitive and willing to explore new things. This inborn desire for freedom and creativity is likely to delight their Entrepreneur parents.

However, while Entrepreneurs tend to have an excellent grasp of reality, impressive practical skills, and the ability to focus completely on what's

in front of them by immersing themselves fully in the present moment, their Diplomat kids may have difficulties recognizing and understanding such traits due to their detachment from the practical world. Luckily, Entrepreneurs' ability to implement their Diplomat children's ideas can create a multitude of opportunities for building bonds.

It's likely that Diplomat kids can always find something to focus on, even without their Entrepreneur parents' help. This is likely to delight Entrepreneurs – however, parents with this personality type should ensure that their daughters and sons have available activities that offer enough mental stimulation. Diplomats are idealistic and even somewhat poetic individuals, and these characteristics may baffle practical and rational-minded Entrepreneurs. For example, while these parents may see planting trees as a fun physical exercise, their Diplomat children may ponder what would happen if everyone in their city did the same – and then cheerfully present that idea to their parents.

Impulsive versus Idealistic

Just like Entrepreneurs, Diplomat children are also likely to understand the importance of personal responsibility and the need to be able to make their own decisions. However, Entrepreneurs with an unbalanced approach to parenting may confuse this with their own tendency to experiment and push limits. Diplomats seek to develop strong inner principles and tend to pick noble, often too-idealistic goals, and may respond better to arguments based on values and principles than to rewards and practical benefits. It's worth remembering that Diplomats tend to be much more sensitive and empathetic than Entrepreneurs. Parents belonging to this type are likely to need to make conscious efforts to connect with their children emotionally.

This aspect is likely to cause most of the tension between Entrepreneur parents and their Diplomat kids. Like other Explorers, Entrepreneurs tend to be very selective about what interests them and have little patience for things that don't fall into that category. However, Diplomats prefer to dive deep and try to find something fascinating in everything they encounter, even when it promises few tangible rewards. Entrepreneur parents may need to at least pretend to be interested in their children's musings or find activities to share that combine opportunities for personal growth with real-world experiences.

Accepting and Encouraging Differences

Entrepreneur parents should remember their Diplomat sons and daughters require a different approach compared to what is natural for them, and they shouldn't attempt to "fix" their children's idealism or occasional naïveté. Rather, these parents should try to appreciate (and learn from) their children's enthusiasm, open-mindedness, and creativity.

Diplomats' abilities are often underappreciated and rejected as offering little practical value, so a little encouragement can go a long way. Such issues are even more important during the teenage years. Thankfully, being nonconformists themselves, Entrepreneurs are likely to encourage their Diplomat children to pursue something that inspires and motivates them, and then help them along the way, instead of criticizing their habits or pushing them to look for more conventional career paths.

Entrepreneur Parent and a Sentinel Child

Practical and Perceptive

Entrepreneurs share the Observant trait with their Sentinel children, which means that communication is likely to be relatively uncomplicated in these families. Both types focus on practicality and facts, preferring to leave theoretical and abstract conversations to Intuitive Analysts and Diplomats. Expectations tend to be straightforward, and Sentinel children always know exactly where they stand with their Entrepreneur parents.

The Observant trait also effects how these types experience their environment, and both Entrepreneur parents and their Sentinel kids are

perceptive and focus on what's happening around them in the moment. Entrepreneurs notice even subtle changes in their children's behavior, allowing them to respond quickly and efficiently to prevent situations from escalating to an unmanageable level. This perceptiveness also promotes a connection between these parents and children, which is especially important when their approach to parenting is unbalanced – Entrepreneurs can be insensitive and lacking in empathy.

Not Enough Structure

Sentinel children are likely to be very dutiful and obedient, trying hard to meet their parents' expectations. They're likely to respect family hierarchy and traditional roles and expect their parents to set up a structured environment with well-defined rules. Sentinels don't like to discover what's acceptable through trial and error the way Entrepreneurs do – they must clearly understand what's okay and what isn't in advance. This is rarely the main goal of freedom-minded Entrepreneurs, although these parents are likely to appreciate their children's willingness to cooperate and listen to what they have to say.

Sentinel children seek a safe, stable atmosphere above all else – spontaneity and fun can come *after* their parents meet these needs. Entrepreneurs should recognize these different requirements and remember that their Sentinel kids are likely to be far more careful, traditional, and methodical in their exploration of the world. When caring for Sentinel children, their somewhat *laissez-faire* approach to parenting may not be ideal.

Respecting the Need for Stability

Sentinel children – and many young children in general – need stability to build trusting relationships with their parents. Sentinels desire steadiness and structure more than any other personality type, and they'll struggle to connect with parents who don't provide such environments for them. Although they thrive on spontaneity and adventure, Entrepreneur parents must modify their behavior to best meet the needs of their children, especially in their early years. From keeping a consistent feeding schedule to creating a bedtime routine, Entrepreneurs can create the sense of security and dependability that their Sentinel children crave.

It's also important for Entrepreneurs to respect their kids' aversion to risk-taking. Sentinels aren't the thrill-seeking type, making them less likely to be interested in riding roller coasters or trying new foods. And, while they benefit from moving outside of their comfort zone every so often, it's important to do so slowly and with their approval – breaking Sentinel children's trust is one of the most harmful mistakes parents can make.

Start by adding new spices to food they already like rather than forcing them to try a foreign food. Take them for a ride on the carousel and then gradually introduce them to more intense rides. Entrepreneurs tend to find that Sentinel children who trust them and can take their time trying new things are usually much more willing partners for future adventures.

Entrepreneur Parent and an Explorer Child

Adventurous and Independent

Naturally, Entrepreneur parents find it easiest to communicate with their sons and daughters if they belong to one of the Explorer types. Explorer children are very adventurous and practical, often able to come up with exciting activities on their own if they're encouraged and given enough freedom to express themselves. Entrepreneurs are likely to be fascinated by their children's curiosity, finding it easy to relate to and communicate with them.

Furthermore, Explorer children tend to feel very in tune with the present moment and the world around them, and often enjoy sports and nature, even from a very young age. Nature-related activities are likely to form a large part of Entrepreneur parents' repertoire.

Like Entrepreneurs themselves, Explorer kids are also likely to place a lot of importance on freedom and independence, often insisting on being allowed to experiment and do things in their own way. Entrepreneurs are likely to cherish seeing their curious and enthusiastic children discover something new or exhaust themselves while spending hours on recently acquired hobbies.

Such an improvisational and hands-off attitude is, however, a double-edged sword. Knowing that their children love freedom of action, Entrepreneurs may be reluctant to discipline them for overstepping their boundaries with all those experiments, or to be firm in telling their kids that time for play is over and they should get back to studying.

Missing the Big Picture

Tangentially, Entrepreneur parents may also have difficulties teaching their Explorer children to find time for introspection and personal development. All Explorers tend to be far more interested in real and tangible matters than internal discussions or abstract ideas, but both approaches have valuable things to offer. It's way too easy for these types to both forget to find time to stop and think about the direction their lives are going if they each live mostly in the present.

Finally, as Entrepreneurs focus more on improvisation and thinking on their feet, they have difficulties with purely administrative and practical tasks. Their Explorer daughters and sons are likely to share this weakness, which is why parents with this personality type should make conscious efforts to teach their children the importance of being economical, to make fact-based decisions, and to combine their restless curiosity with practical needs and responsibilities.

Consider the Future

As pleasant as it can be to live in the present moment, Entrepreneurs do their Explorer children a disservice when they neglect to consider the future. Encouraging their Explorer kids to view life as an adventure seems harmless enough, but children who lack direction or the ability to form well-thought-out plans can venture into some unsavory situations. Going to college with absolutely no direction can cause frustration and some heavy student loans with no degree to show for it. Buying their

first cars without the know-how to budget for payments, insurance, or fuel can result in repossessed vehicles and badly-damaged credit scores.

To prevent these potential long-term issues, Entrepreneur parents should be intentional about helping their children understand how their present actions affect their future. Kids of all ages (even adolescents) aren't cognitively capable of fully understanding the potential consequences of their behaviors, and it's their parents' job to help them until they develop that ability.

As impulsive individuals themselves, Entrepreneurs must explore how their lack of planning or direction may have affected their lives. An anecdote about a poor decision they made as a child ("I decided to try some beer at a friend's party my sophomore year in high school.") and the negative outcome that resulted from that decision ("I got really sick, and my parents grounded me for two months when they found out.") can help to illustrate the importance of considering future consequences.

Conclusion

Balancing their refreshing spontaneity and somewhat *laissez-faire* attitude with the responsibilities that come with parenthood can be a challenge for Entrepreneur parents. But if they master the right approach, they not only raise children who are capable and responsible, but there is also an element of whimsy and adventure built in. It doesn't matter what personality type their children turn out to be. Smart discipline and the teaching of responsibility paired with the unique personality style of the Entrepreneur can help kids experience the best of both worlds.

Responsible parents always adapt themselves, regardless of their own core inclinations, to raise their children compassionately and intelligently. If Entrepreneurs see parenting as a skill to acquire and try to do so, they're likely to be marvelous, conscientious parents who open unique doors in sometimes unconventional ways.

Final Words

For Entrepreneurs, life without other people would be – in a word – boring. Being around others lights up Entrepreneurs, motivating them to bring their best and brightest energy to each interaction. People with this personality type invigorate their partners, make their friends feel alive, and – if they become parents – teach their children just how fascinating the world can be.

Entrepreneurs' charm and adventurousness can be magnetic. But that doesn't mean that they won't face any challenges in their relationships. To build close and lasting connections, Entrepreneurs often need to learn how to temper their bluntness with a dose of sensitivity and their impulsiveness with enough reliability to make the people they care about feel valued and secure. At times, these efforts may take Entrepreneurs out of their comfort zones – but the good news is that people with this personality type excel at venturing beyond their comfort zones.

In these pages, we've discussed common tendencies that Entrepreneurs tend to bring to their romantic relationships, their friendships, and their roles as parents. Our hope is that these insights will equip you to build and sustain relationships that make each day more interesting – and that grow even more meaningful and rewarding with every passing year.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you better understand and strengthen your relationships? Explore our Relationship Tools and Assessments.
- Looking to enhance your academic or professional life? Check out the *Entrepreneur Guide to Careers*.
- Ready to build a strong foundation for your self-development? Our *Entrepreneur Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

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